Research Article

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‘Pre’ and ‘post’ marking in Nanosyntax: the case of a prepositional dative in a dialectal Polish

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Abstract: The Podlasie dialect of Polish exhibits a curious nominal case declension paradigm where the dative is expressed by a preposition and a genitive suffix (PREP N-GEN), which constitutes a typologically rare pattern. Moreover, the instrumental in this dialect, which is hierarchically above the dative, is marked with only a suffix (N-INS), unexpectedly dropping the preposition. The fact that a hierarchically higher case drops a preposition challenges a generalization made in Caha (2009), which builds on Blake's (2001) hierarchy concerning the morphological marking of case. The paper explores how these two atypical patterns follow from the Nanosyntactic lexicalization procedure, offering an analysis that contributes to the discussion of ‘pre’ and ‘post’ marking in morphosyntax. The analysis also sheds light on why the pattern of the case declension attested in the Podlasie dialect is typologically rare.

Keywords: Nanosyntax, case, lexicalization, Podlasie dialect, Polish

1 Introduction: prepositional dative in the Podlasie dialect

This paper is concerned with a typologically rare nominal case declension paradigm in the Podlasie dialect of Polish. Of particular interest is the manner in which the complex dative marking in this dialect follows from the Nanosyntactic lexicalization algorithm — the procedure by which syntactic projections are mapped onto morphological exponents and linearized as pre- and post-markers (see, e.g., De Clercq et al. (2025) and Starke (2025)). The analysis helps explain the source of the typological rarity of the Podlasie case marking pattern.

A characteristic feature of this dialect is its complex dative, which is sometimes referred to as the dative construction (see, for instance, Gardzińska (2001: 153–167) and the references there).[1] Namely, the dative is marked by the preposition *dla* and the genitive suffix on the noun, according to the following format.

(1) dla N-GEN

This pattern is attested in a range of dative constructions, which include recipients of ditransitive constructions (as, e.g., in (2)), objects of monotransitive verbs (in (3)), objects of reflexive transitive verbs (in (4)), or dative subjects (in (5)).

(2) Przekazaliśmy **dla** miast-**a** dotację.
give.PST.M.1PL DLA city-N.GEN donation.F.ACC
‘We gave the city a donation.’

1 The dialect is spoken in Białystok and certain other parts of Podlasie in the North-Eastern Poland.

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(3) Pomagamy **dla** Adam-**a**.
help.PRS.1PL DLA Adam-M.GEN
'We help Adam.'

(4) Poddali się **dla** przeciwnik-**a**.
surrender.PST.1PL REFL DLA opponent-M.GEN
'They surrendered to the opponent.'

(5) a. **Dla** Adam-**a** jest zimno.
DLA Adam-M.GEN is cold
'Adam is cold.'
b. **Dla** Adam-**a** to się podoba.
DLA Adam-M.GEN it REFL like
'Adam likes it.'

What is unusual about this dative marking is that it is the only prepositional case in the case declension paradigm in this dialect, as shown in Table 1 on the example of three nouns that belong to different gender inflection classes.

Tab. 1: Case marking in the Podlasie dialect.

	city n.sg	**sir/man m.sg**	**wife f.sg**
NOM	miast-o	pan-∅	żon-a
ACC	miast-o	pan-a	żon-ę
GEN	miast-**a**	pan-**a**	żon-**y**
LOC	miast-u	pan-u	żoni-e
DAT	dla miast-**a**	dla pan-**a**	dla żon-**y**
INS	miast-em	pan-em	żon-ą

With this respect the Podlasie dialect differs from standard Polish where all case forms are suffixal, as shown in Table 2.

Tab. 2: Case marking in standard Polish.

	city n.sg	**sir/man m.sg**	**wife f.sg**
NOM	miast-o	pan-∅	żon-a
ACC	miast-o	pan-a	żon-ę
GEN	miast-a	pan-a	żon-y
LOC	miast-u	pan-u	żoni-e
DAT	miast-u	pan-u	żoni-e
INS	miast-em	pan-em	żon-ą

Consequently, the examples with the prepositional dative in the Podlasie sentences in (2)–(5) will all involve suffixal dative in standard Polish as in, respectively, (6)–(9).

(6) Przekazaliśmy miast-**u** dotację.
give.PST.M.1PL city-N.DAT donation.F.ACC
'We gave the city a donation.'

(7) Pomagamy Adam-**owi**.
help.PRS.1PL Adam-M.DAT
'We help Adam.'

(8) Poddali się przeciwnik-**owi**.
surrender.PST.1PL REFL opponent-M.DAT
'They surrendered to the opponent.'

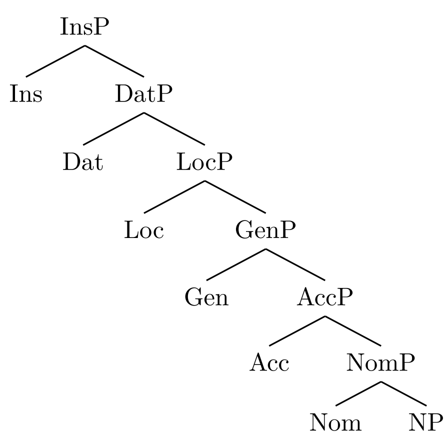
(9) a. Adam-**owi** jest zimno.
Adam-M.DAT is cold
'Adam is cold.'

b. Adam-**owi** to się podoba.
Adam-M.DAT it REFL like
'Adam likes it.'

The shape of the paradigm in Table 1 is exceptional in light of the morphological marking of cases as described by Blake (2001) and further formalized in Caha (2009). Caha (2009) adopts a version of the universal hierarchy of cases originally proposed by Blake (2001), shown in (10). Blake's hierarchy underlies his generalization that if a language has a case that is morphologically realized as a suffix, it will generally also have all cases to its left in this sequence realized as suffixes, too. If a given case is marked by a prefix, then all cases to its right in this sequence are also marked by prefixes.

(10) NOM < ACC < GEN < LOC < DAT < INS

Caha (2009) argues that (10) follows from the universal sequence of syntactic case heads (the case *fseq*) as in (11). The case *fseq* is projected on top of an (articulate) NP and each case feature heads its own phrase to the effect that individual cases like nominative, accusative, genitive, etc., are in a syntactic containment relation.[2]

(11)


If we assume the case *fseq* in (11), the Podlasie paradigm in Table 1 exhibits two intriguing properties.

First, the noun with the dative preposition *dla* takes the genitive suffix, the case that is not adjacent to the dative. Such a pattern constitutes a cross-linguistically rare example of a case preposition that does not select the noun suffixed with an exactly one notch lower case (see Caha (2009: 44)). I will call this situation the "low case suffix" problem.[3]

2 The case *fseq* is inferred from the observation that syncretism targets only contiguous cells of a paradigm (the so-called *ABA generalization, see e.g. Bobaljik (2012)).

3 Caha (2009: 94) mentions Modern Greek as an exceptional example of a similar type as the one attested in the Podlasie dialect. The biggest suffixal case in Modern Greek is genitive, yet the instrumental preposition *me* 'with' selects accusative-marked NPs, as in:

(i) me t-on Petr-o
with the-ACC Peter-ACC
'with the Peter'

The other intriguing property of the paradigm in Table 1 concerns the instrumental: it is higher in the case hierarchy than the dative but it is marked only with a suffix, despite the fact that the marking of the dative involves a preposition. Such a case marking pattern constitutes a challenge for Caha’s (2009: 30, 44) formalization of Blake’s hierarchy, which states that if a given case is marked by a suffix, all preceding cases in that language are also suffixal. In terms of the lexicalization of the case *fseq* in (11), this means that the realization of the instrumental on top of the dative results in an odd-looking disappearance of the dative preposition *dla*.

The task is, thus, (i) to explore how exactly these two facts follow from the application of the Nanosyntactic lexicalization algorithm, a procedure that determines how a syntactic sequence of heads becomes realized by lexical items and (ii) understand why these facts are typologically rare.

The remainder of the paper is organized as follows. Section 2 discusses the mechanism by which syntactic trees are mapped onto morphological exponents in Nanosyntax and summarizes the implications of this process for the linear realization of morphemes as either ‘pre’ or ‘post’ markers. Section 3 addresses the “low case suffix” problem in the dialectal Polish. Section 4 provides an analysis of deriving a suffixal instrumental from a prepositional dative construction that is based on an updated formulation of the lexicalization algorithm. The nature of the derivations that lead to the realization of the dative and the instrumental in the Podlasie dialect in sections 3 and 4 help explain why these two patterns are typologically rare. Section 5 is a conclusion.

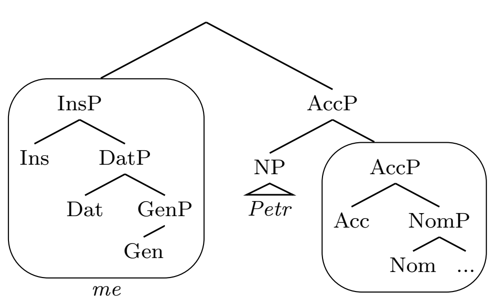
2 ‘Pre’ and ‘post’ marking in Nanosyntax

Nanosyntax is a theory of the syntax – lexicon interface in which morphemes correspond to phrasal syntactic structures where each grammatical feature heads its own phrase (Starke (2009), Caha (2009), Baunaz & Lander (2018), among many others). The central claim of this model is that lexical items (roots and affixes) are lexically stored constituents that are paired with phonetic exponents. To illustrate the mechanics of morphological marking, the section first outlines suffixal marking, taking the Podlasie nominative/accusative suffix -*o* as an example, and then it moves on to prefixal marking, as instantiated by the English genitive marker *of*. Next, the section introduces the lexicalization algorithm that yields a principled formal distinction between ‘pre’ and ‘post’ markers. The core prediction is that ‘post’ elements, derived through evacuation movement, have a unary-branching foot, while ‘pre’ elements, analyzed as subderived complex left branches, have a binary-branching foot.

Assuming the *fseq* in (11), a lexical entry of an accusative marker *o* as in *miast-o* ‘city-ACC’ seen in Table 1 will have the following shape:

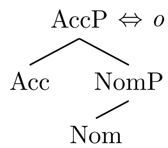
To explain this pattern, Caha (2009) proposes that the syntactic representation of the prefix *me* includes the instrumental but also the dative and genitive features, as in (ii). The presence of GenP at the bottom of *me* requires, in Caha’s analysis, that it merges with a one notch smaller base, i.e., AccP.

(ii)



While a similar solution can be pursued for the Podlasie paradigm, the issue that we set out to resolve is how such a pattern follows from the Nanosyntactic lexicalization procedure.

(12) Lexical item



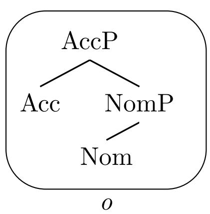
A central principle is the Condition on Matching (also known as the Superset Principle), as in (13), which regulates the realization of a syntactic tree with an exponent of a lexically stored item.

(13) Condition on Matching (De Clercq et al. (2025: 12))
A lexically stored constituent L matches a syntactic phrase S iff S is identical to L.

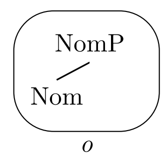
This condition allows a lexical item in (12) to lexicalize both syntactic trees in (14) with the exponent *o*, i.e. both the accusative structure in (a) and the nominative structure in (b).

(14) Syntactically derived trees

a.



b.



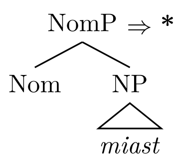
This is so because any syntactic subconstituent of a lexically stored tree is itself stored in the lexicon. That is why both trees in (14) find a matching node in the lexical entry in (12). This situation not only results in nominative/accusative syncretism seen in Table 1 but also explains a cross-linguistically attested observation that syncretism applies to contiguous cells of a paradigm (the *ABA generalization in Bobaljik (2012)).

Syntactic structure building and its lexicalization proceeds via the lexicalization algorithm in (15), which is an ordered set of syntactic operations. Each operation ends with an attempt to match a newly derived constituent with an exponent of an existing lexical item.

(15) Lexicalization algorithm (LA, adapted from Starke (2022))
1. Merge F and lexicalize directly.
2. Evacuate the closest labelled node containing the bottom *fseq*.
3. Evacuate the immediately dominating node. (applies recursively)
4. Merge XP.
5. Backtrack.

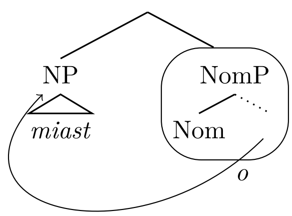
A key assumption of this algorithm is that syntactic features (Fs) are merged cyclically, one at a time, and that each newly formed structure must be successfully lexicalized before the derivation can proceed to Merge the next F. To enable this, the structure resulting from each Merge operation is checked against the language’s inventory of lexical entries. If a lexical item that matches the structure is found, the derivation advances with the next Merge F cycle. If no such item is available, the syntax attempts to salvage the derivation by applying evacuation movements (steps 2. and 3. of the LA) and tries to lexicalize the remnants created in the movement process. This can be illustrated with the formation and lexicalization of the nominative form *miast-o* ‘city-NOM’ in (16). Step 1. involves the merger of the Nominative feature on top of the NP *miast* but it does not result in a direct lexicalization (i.e., there is no lexical item that matches this tree (in (16)).

(16) Merge F and lexicalize (fails)



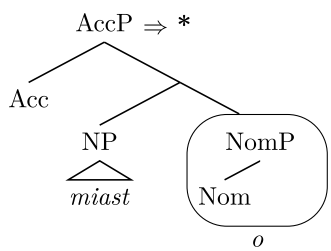
Hence, step 2. ensues, which involves the evacuation movement of the closest (from the root of the tree) labelled constituent that contains the bottom *fseq*, which is the NP *miast*. Following the evacuation movement, the remnant NomP becomes lexicalized as *o*, a subset spellout of the lexical item in (12), and becomes linearized as the suffix (in (17)).

(17) Evacuate the closest labelled node containing the bottom *fseq*.



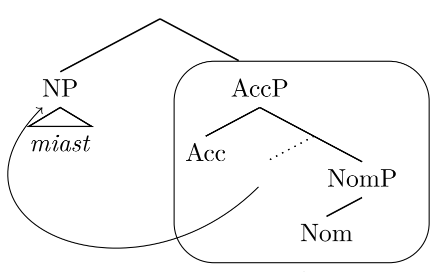
Two remarks are in place regarding this step. First, the identification of the node that is targeted by evacuation as the one that contains the bottom *fseq*, the NP in this case, is an equivalent of Cinque's (2005) U20 constraint on moving (with) the bottom noun. Second, the nodes created by evacuation movement are unlabelled, as in (17). The importance of labelled and unlabelled nodes for step 2. of the LA is clear with the merger of the next case feature, Acc, as in (18), and the subsequent failure to lexicalize the resulting AccP directly.

(18)



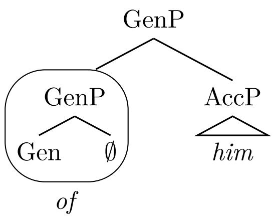
Given the lexicalization failure of the AccP in (18), the next step is to identify the node for the evacuation movement. According to the formulation in (15.2), this node is the NP, since it is the only node that jointly meets the requirements on being labelled and containing the bottom *fseq*. The evacuation of the NP results in the successful lexicalization of the remnant AccP as (the superset spellout of) of the lexical item *o* in (12), which over-rides the earlier lexicalization of NomP, as in:

(19)



Should all listed evacuation movements fail, the procedure reaches step 4. of the LA, ‘Merge XP’. This is a repair strategy where a second workspace is opened. The feature F becomes removed from the main derivation and gets merged in this newly created phrasal constituent. Assuming that every Merge operation is binary, according to Starke (2025), this subderivation is spawned by merging the feature F with an empty set (indicated as ∅ in what follows).[4] Upon the merger of the subconstituent derived in this way with the main tree, it becomes its complex left branch (CLB) and — if matching is successful — it gets linearized as a ‘pre’ element (a prefix or a preposition) on the main tree.[5] The English genitive preposition *of* is an instance of such a derivation, as illustrated in (20) on the example of *of him*.

(20)

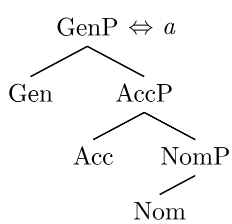


Here, the lexicalization of the Genitive feature requires the formation of the CLB, which becomes spelled out as *of* upon its merger with the main tree, the AccP *him*. In case this last resort strategy does not result lexicalization, the derivation will backtrack to the previous cycle, a situation which will be discussed in detail in the context of dative marking in the Podlasie dialect shortly.

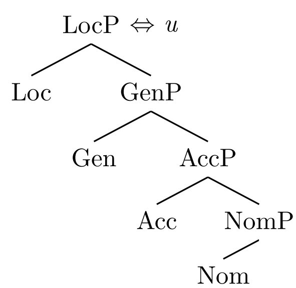
With this background in place, we can now turn to the analytical goals of this paper: the unexpected genitive case as the sister to the dative preposition and a return to a ‘suffix only’ marking in the instrumental case in the dialectal Polish. Both problems can be resolved if the list of the Podlasie case markers comprises the following lexical items.

(21) Lexical items

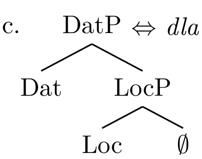
a.



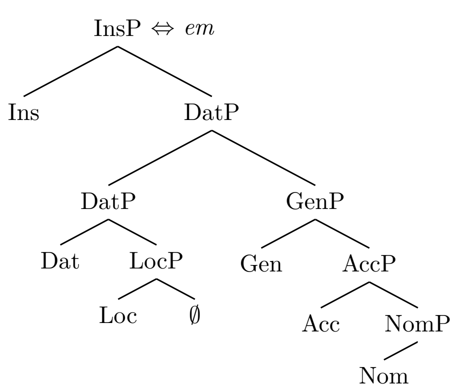
b.



c.



d.



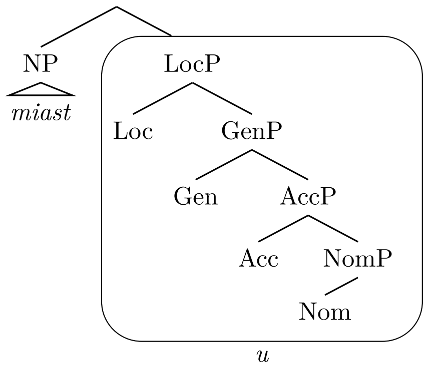
4 The idea that an empty set can serve as a base for the merger of a syntactic feature F was put forward in De Belder & Craenenbroeck (2015), who build on Zwart’s (2011) proposal that the first application of Merge involves an empty set.

5 In contrast to evacuated constituents, which become re-merged as (non-projecting) specifiers, subderived complex left branches function as complex heads, in the sense that they provide the label upon the merger with the main tree. This is clearly visible in contexts like the one in the Podlasie dialect where the merger of the Instrumental feature takes place on top of the dative structure that is formed with a preposition, i.e. a labelling CLB. For a related discussion of CLBs in Nanosyntax see Starke (2018), Wiland (2019, 2025), Caha (2019), or Dekier (2022), among others.

3 The “low case suffix” problem

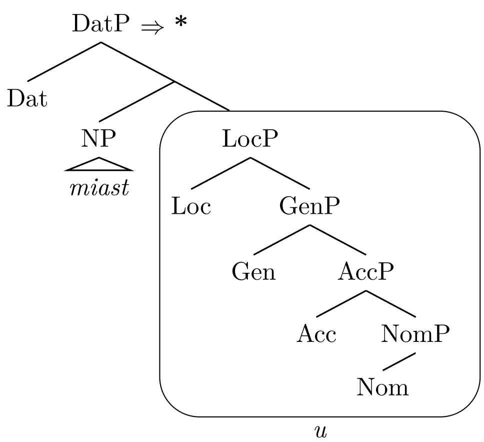
The “low case suffix” problem can be traced to the stage of the derivation where the dative case feature merges with the locative structure. Let the locative form *miast-u* ‘city-LOC’ in (22) serve as the working example, whose LocP is lexicalized as *u* of the lexical entry in (21b).

(22)



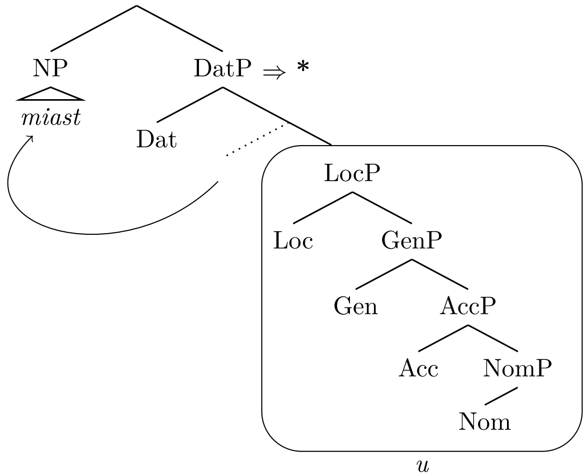
The merger of the next feature in line, the Dative, is followed by an attempt to lexicalize the resulting structure, as in (23).

(23) Merge Dat and lexicalize (fails)



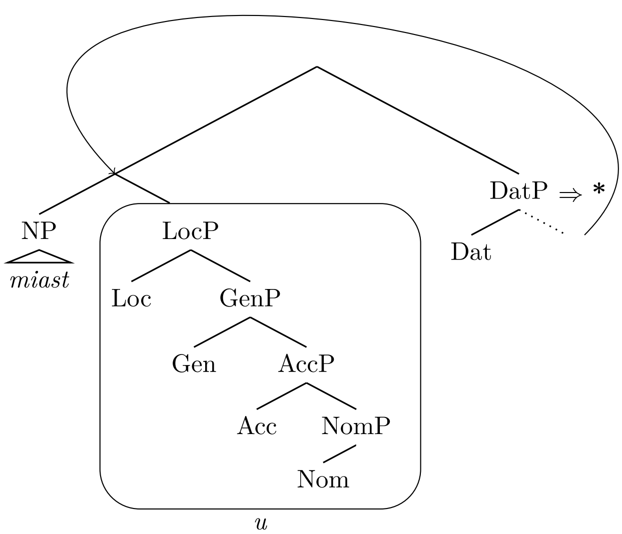
This first step of the LA results in lexicalization failure since no lexically stored constituent in (12) or (21) matches such a syntactic tree and, consequently, step 2. of the algorithm is attempted:

(24) Evacuate the closest labelled node containing the bottom *fseq* (i.e., the NP).



Since this attempt also fails to match an existing lexical entry, the NP movement is undone and step 3. of the LA kicks in, which results in the pied-piping of the sister to the Dat head:

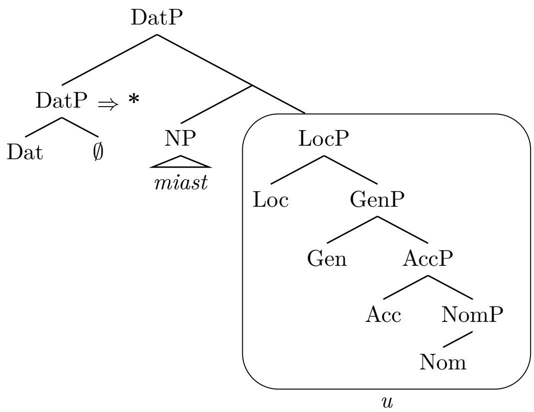
(25) Evacuate the immediately dominating node (fails)



Again, this operation does not lead to a successful lexicalization with any existing lexical item.

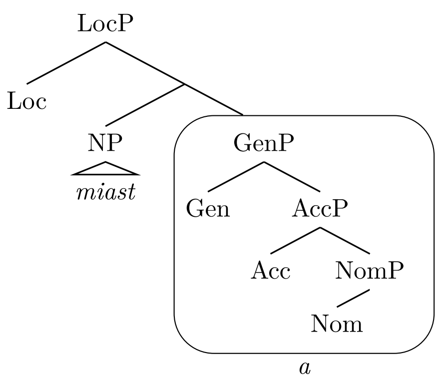
According to the LA, the next step is Merge XP, which means to remove the Dat head from the main tree and start a new workspace by merging Dat with the empty set. This leads to the formation of a CLB upon its merger with the main tree (as discussed in section 2). This step is illustrated in (26) and it also results in a lexicalization failure as no lexical entry matches the CLB.

(26) Merge XP (fails)



Failure to lexicalize the CLB in (26) leads the derivation to resort to the last option of the LA: backtracking. Backtracking means undoing all the movements and steps of Merge F and going back to the the previous cycle where F has not been merged yet and the tree reaches no higher than F_{n-1}.[6] In our case, the derivation goes back to the cycle of Merge Loc, as in (27), a stage where the last successfully lexicalized feature is Gen, as the marker *a* of the lexical entry in (21a).

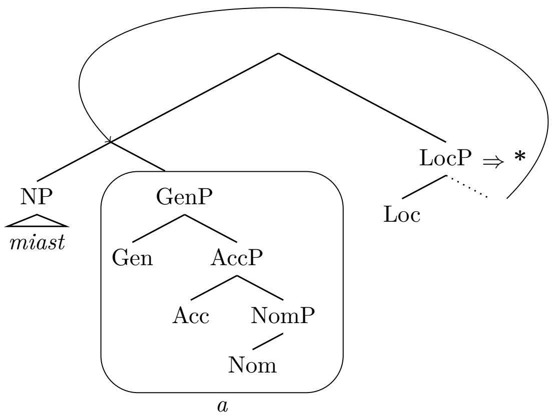
(27) Backtrack to Merge Loc



In the first pass of the Merge Loc cycle, two steps of the LA have already been attempted: step 1. direct lexicalization, which has failed, and step 2. the evacuation of the NP node, which has been successful, as seen in (22). Having reached a point where the derivation cannot lexicalize a higher Dat feature merged on top of (22), the derivation backtracks and undertakes a second pass at the lexicalization of Loc. With steps 1. and 2. already attempted at the first pass, the derivation proceeds to step 3. of the LA, i.e. the pied piping of [NP [GenP]] *miast-a*, as in:

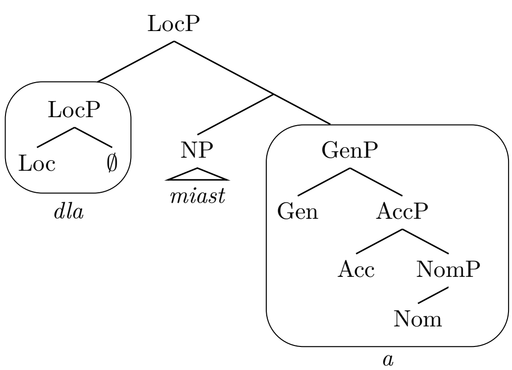
6 For a detailed discussion of backtracking derivations in case declension domains see Caha (2021) and Janků (2022).

(28) Evacuate the immediately dominating node (fails)



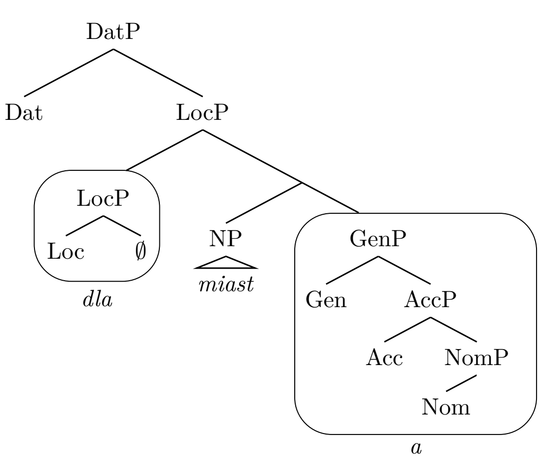
Since this step also fails to result in a successful matching, the derivation moves to step 4. and starts a new workspace with Loc and ∅ as the first Merge, as in (29). This derivation is successful, as the CLB created in this way matches the lexical item in (21c) and gets lexicalized as (the subset spellout of) *dla*.

(29)



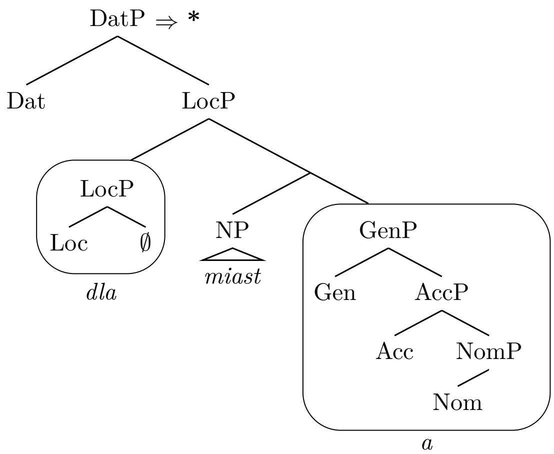
The new Merge F cycle now involves the Dat feature. In order to capture the fact that the sister of the CLB *dla* is genitive, the analytical goal is to ensure that the Dat feature ultimately gets merged inside the CLB. In contrast to Starke (2018), where it is suggested that the existence of a new workspace (the CLB) requires that newly added features be merged with that CLB rather than with the mainline derivation, the revised algorithm proposed in Starke (2025) submits that a new Merge F cycle will first target the mainline derivation, as illustrated in (30), where the Dat feature gets added to the root of the main tree. Starke (2025) refers to this operation as “grow closest workspace”, which corresponds to the top-most LocP node in (30).

(30)



The resulting structure is subsequently subject to the standard lexicalization (LA) procedures. Given the list of lexical entries in (12) and (21), the direct lexicalization of the tree in (30) does not result in a successful matching, as marked below with “*” for the sake of clarity.

(31) Direct lexicalization of Dat (fails)



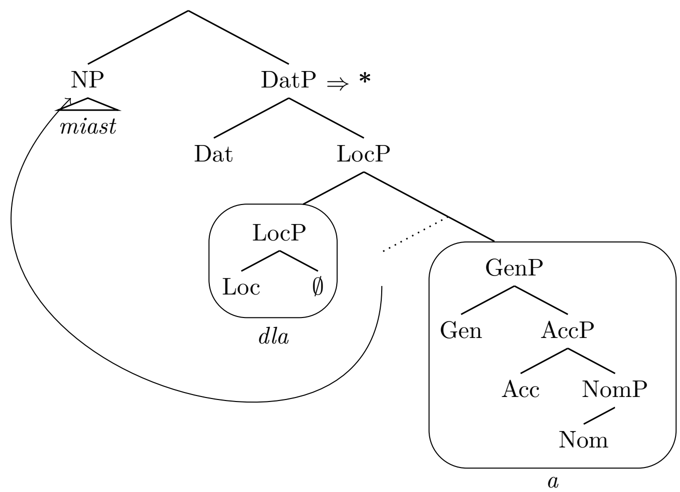
That leads to the application of step 2. of the LA. However, its formulation in (15.2) as “evacuate the closest labelled node containing the bottom *fseq*” will target the top LocP *dla miast-a* for movement in the representation in (30). This is an unwelcome result given that we have so far successfully worked with the NP as the closest node marked for evacuation movement. A possible solution to that problem is to reformulate step 2. of the LA as follows:

(32) Evacuate the closest labelled non-remnant node containing the bottom *fseq*.

The “non-remnant node” refers here to a constituent that does not host an evacuation gap, which in nanosyntactic terms is equivalent to an XP without a unary foot. The inclusion of the non-remnant clause in (32) combines Starke’s (2022) formulation from (15.2) and Caha’s (2023) alternative. As mentioned in section 2, Starke’s (2022) formulation is essentially a nanosyntactic equivalent of Cinque’s (2005) observation that, in certain movement configurations, only a bottom-most constituent undergoes displacement (in Cinque’s U20 analysis, it is a lexical noun in an articulate NP structure that can move). This constraint is coupled with the general locality principle that targets the structurally closest candidate for movement. In contrast, Caha (2023) adopts a different specification, which replaces Starke’s “evacuate the closest labelled node containing the bottom *fseq*” for “evacuate the closest labelled non-remnant constituent” (for a discussion of both formulations see De Clercq et al. (2025: 33–34)).[7] Thus, while both versions are identical regarding the locality and labelling constraints, they differ in whether they refer to the bottom of the *fseq* or to a non-remnant status of the moving constituent. But neither formulation alone will work for evacuating the NP in a tree with the CLB in (30). While Starke’s formulation will target the top LocP *dla miast-a* as the closest node containing the bottom NP, Caha’s formulation will target the CLB *dla* as the closest labelled non-remnant. Instead, the formulation as in (32) will target the bottom NP as the only node that meets both criteria. This evacuation step is shown in (33) but, again, it results in a lexicalization failure.

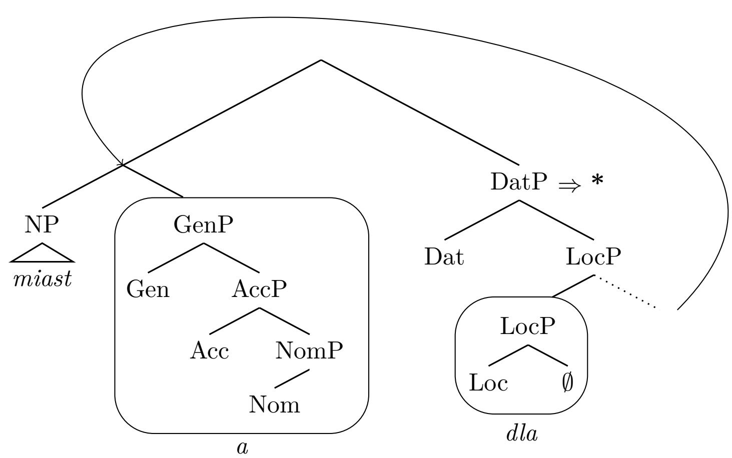
7 I am indebted to an anonymous reviewer for pointing this out.

(33) Evacuate the closest labelled non-remnant node containing the bottom *fseq* (fails)



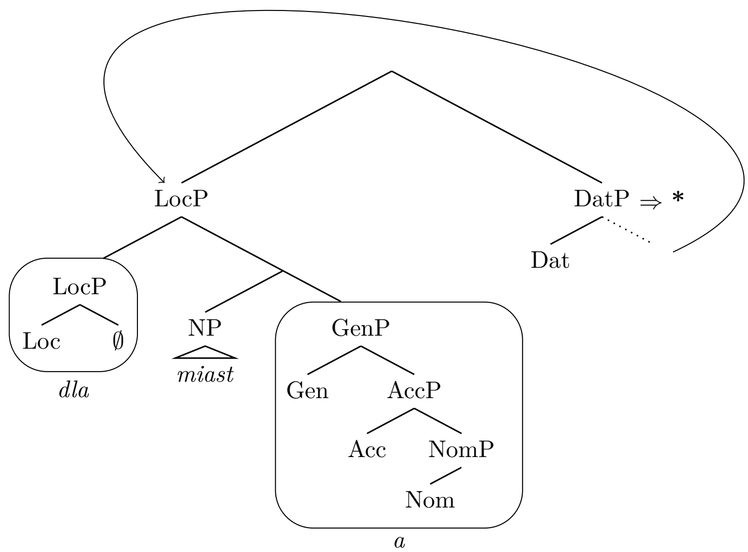
Given the lexicalization failure, this movement is undone and step 3. of the LA is attempted, the pied piping of *miast-a*, as in:

(34) Evacuate an immediately dominating node (fails)



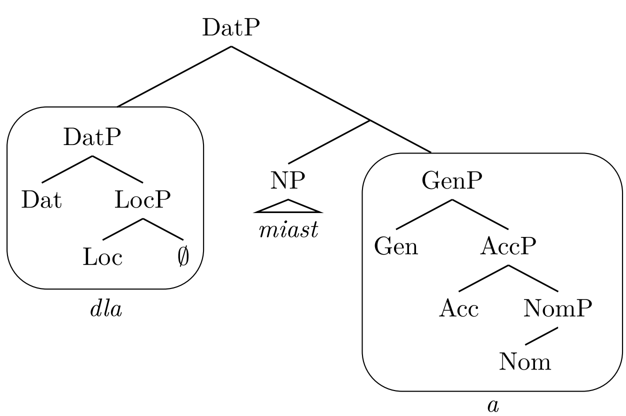
This attempt also fails to result in a lexicalization of the Dat feature so, on the strength of (15.3), the evacuation targets an immediately dominating node, the (top) LocP, as in:

(35)



This attempt fails to yield a successful lexicalization of the Dat feature, too. (Note that the evacuation movement in (35) produces a remnant DatP identical to the one that is non-lexicalizable at the stage in (25) with lexicalization failing here for the same reason). Hence the evacuation movement is undone and the derivation proceeds to step. 4 of the LA ‘Merge XP’. This takes place by merging the Dat feature in the second closest workspace — the CLB, as in:

(36) Merge XP (successful lexicalization)



The merger of the Dat feature in the CLB leads to a successful lexicalization as the CLB matches the lexical entry in (21c). This derives the surface form *dla miast-a*, the desired result.

To conclude, the fact that the dative preposition *dla* appears with the genitive structure as its sister follows from the fact that both Loc and Dat features are included at the bottom of the CLB that has been created after backtracking. After the backtracking, only Merge XP, which is listed late in the lexicalization procedure, has turned out to be successful in lexicalizing the Dat feature in the Podlasie paradigm. The fact that only such a late derivation yields a successful realization of a case feature may help explain the typological rarity of the pattern where a case preposition selects the noun suffixed with a non-adjacent lower case in the hierarchy.

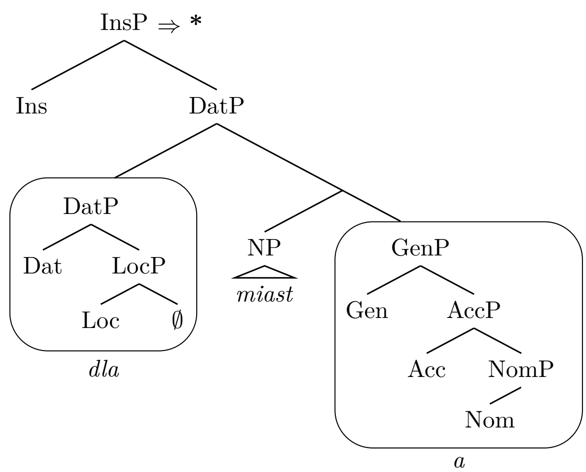
Let us proceed to the other issue with the Podlasie paradigm, which is the disappearance of a preposition in the locative form, a one notch bigger case than the dative.

4 Suffixal instrumental

In order to derive the observed pattern, the instrumental suffix must overwrite the preposition *dla* and the genitive suffix on the noun while leaving the noun itself unaffected. This can be achieved by evacuation movement of the NP node.

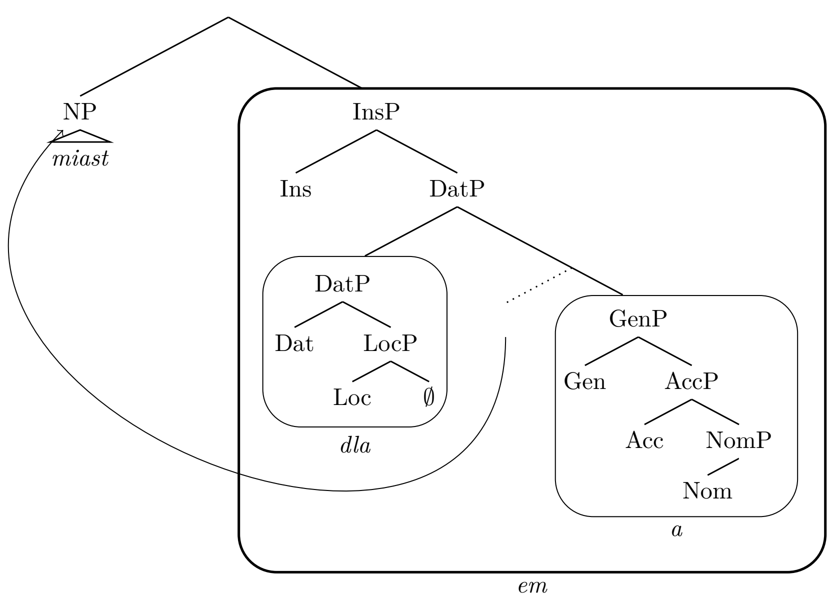
After the lexicalization of the Dat feature, the next Merge F cycle involves the Ins feature. According to the "grow closest workspace" procedure, Ins gets merged with the main tree, as in (37), which is followed by an attempt to lexicalize it directly with a lexical item from the list in (12) and (21).

(37) Merge Ins and lexicalize (fails)



Given that direct lexicalization does not result in a successful matching, the next step is to try the evacuation movement. With the formulation in (32), the constituent that undergoes movement is the NP, as shown below.

(38) Evacuate the closest labelled non-remnant node containing the bottom *fseq* (i.e., the NP)



The evacuation of the NP *miast* results in a successful lexicalization of the remnant InsP as *em*, as it matches the lexical entry in (21d). The realization of the InsP as *em* in this way over-rides the prefix *dla* and the suffix *a* of the dative, which is the desired result.

To summarize the results of the derivations discussed above, the size-relative spans of ‘post’ markers as well as the dative ‘pre’ marker *dla* can be presented in the form of the following lexicalization table.

Tab. 3: Lexical realization of the *miast* paradigm in the Podlasie dialect

	NP	Nom	Acc	Gen	Loc	Dat	Ins
NOM	miast	o					
ACC	miast	o					
GEN	miast	a					
LOC	miast	u					
DAT	miast	a			dla		
INS	miast	em					

5 Conclusion

The realization of the dative with a preposition plus a genitive suffix in the Podlasie dialect comes out as a consequence of lexicalizing the Dat feature in a complex left branch only after backtracking, which is listed later than the CLB formation in the lexicalization procedure.

In turn, the hierarchically higher instrumental that is realized by a suffix alone — the pattern that is a challenge for Caha’s (2009) formalization of Blake’s (2001) case hierarchy — can be analyzed on its own terms. Specifically, it results from the evacuation of the NP across the dative prefix, as shown in (38), which leads to a lexicalization that overrides the complex dative. For this derivation to be possible, the evacuation movement must be defined in such a way that it targets a bottom *fseq* (the NP) across a prefix branch. The realization of a tree derived in this way requires a complex lexical entry, the one with a CLB, which arguably explains why such a pattern is typologically rare.

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